Newsweek

REVOPS · TAG CERTIFIED AGAINST FRAUD

Updating the IVT Monitoring Report

A step-by-step guide for anyone, even if you have never heard of TAG: where every number comes from and how it reaches the deck we send the auditors

START HERE

Why this deck exists

TAG (the Trustworthy Accountability Group) is an ad-industry body. Its Certified Against Fraud (CAF) seal lets Newsweek show buyers that we prevent and remove invalid traffic, not just measure it. To keep the seal, TAG's auditors ask for evidence. The IVT Monitoring Report is that evidence, and this guide refreshes it every month.

WHAT AUDITORS NEED TO SEE · 1

Every pageview is screened

DoubleVerify checks each page before ads are requested (pre-bid).

PROVED BY: DV-GA WORKBOOK

WHAT AUDITORS NEED TO SEE · 2

Every impression is measured

DoubleVerify measures the impressions Ad Manager serves (post-bid).

PROVED BY: DV-GAM WORKBOOK

WHAT AUDITORS NEED TO SEE · 3

Invalid traffic stays low

DV's SIVT rate, month by month and quarter by quarter.

PROVED BY: DV-GAM WORKBOOK

START HERE

The words you'll see in this guide

Term	Meaning
IVT	Invalid traffic: impressions not seen by a real person
GIVT	General IVT: known bots and crawlers, caught by lists
SIVT	Sophisticated IVT: hijacked devices, bots posing as people. Hard to detect
Pre-bid	DV checks a page before any ad is requested; risky pages get no ads
Post-bid	DV measures each impression after it has served
Discrepancy	The gap between two counts of the same thing, as a %

Term	Meaning
GAM	Google Ad Manager, the ad server that counts our impressions
DV	DoubleVerify, our verification vendor. Its web UI is Pinnacle
GA4	Google Analytics 4, where pageviews are counted
Ad Exchange	Google's exchange. Its count already includes Private Auction
Open Bidding	Other exchanges bidding inside Ad Manager
PA · PD · PG	Private Auction · Preferred Deal · Programmatic Guaranteed

START HERE

Before you start

ACCESS

Logins you need

- Google Ad Manager reporting, network 22541732127
- DoubleVerify Pinnacle · Publisher Suite
- GA4 property 359317277 and DV's shared pre-bid Drive folder

FILES

Where things live

- SharePoint: yield › Documents › TAG › <year>
- One folder per year; start a new one each January

Open the TAG folder

TIMING

When to run it

- Every month, ~3 days after it closes, so DV data is complete
- TAG's deadline falls close to the end of the year
- AAM's review call follows in January (Appendix)

PEOPLE

Who reviews and receives it

- Review: Michael (CTO), Kelly Liu (SVP Yield & AdOps)
- Send to: Katrina Eddy, VP Tech Assurance, AAM
- katrina.eddy@auditedmedia.com · O 203-447-2883
- Cc: Jonathan Reid · TechAssurance@auditedmedia.com

Newsweek

WHAT WE HAND TO TAG

The IVT Monitoring Report, slide by slide

1	**Cover** Title and year	UPDATE EACH MONTH	
2	**Executive summary** What TAG CAF is and why it matters		
3	**Year review** Section divider		
4	**GA4 vs DV pre-bid** Pre-bid coverage, by month and quarter	UPDATE EACH MONTH	
5	**DV coverage** Pre-bid and post-bid, 100% of the site		
6	**GAM filtering** The second layer of protection, after DV		
7	**Two pathways to ad quality** DV and GAM together		
8	**Key changes** Anything that moved traffic or measurement	UPDATE EACH MONTH	
9	**SIVT by quarter** Overall, display and video	UPDATE EACH MONTH	
10	**Thank you** Closing slide		

Shaded slides change every month (Step 5). The rest stay as they are unless the setup changes. The next two slides show the finished data slides.

Newsweek

WHAT WE HAND TO TAG · PRE-BID SLIDE

GA4 pageviews vs DV pre-bid

Goal: show TAG auditors that DV monitors every pageview.

BY MONTH

Month	Pageviews	DV pre-bid	Discrepancy
Jan	88,799,843	86,029,638	3.12%
Feb	76,449,175	73,990,594	3.22%
Mar	78,906,939	76,544,383	2.99%
Apr	44,598,903	43,771,981	1.85%
May	40,298,053	36,840,158	8.58%
Jun	39,401,025	38,439,204	2.44%
Jul	41,820,559	39,544,135	5.44%
Aug	42,787,009	40,292,568	5.83%
Sep	52,642,347	50,519,576	4.03%

BY QUARTER

Quarter	Pageviews	DV pre-bid	Discrepancy
Q1	244,155,957	236,564,615	3.11%
Q2	124,297,981	119,051,343	4.22%
Q3	137,249,915	130,356,279	5.02%
Q4	—	—	—
YTD	**505,703,853**	**485,972,237**	**3.90%**

2026 YTD Jan–Sep from the DV-GA workbook · discrepancy = (pageviews − DV pre-bid) ÷ pageviews. Q4 fills in after December closes.

Newsweek

WHAT WE HAND TO TAG · SIVT SLIDE

Newsweek has consistently low SIVT

Goal: show TAG auditors that SIVT stays under 1%, month after month.

BY MONTH

Month	Overall	Display	Video
Jan	0.04%	0.04%	0.02%
Feb	0.04%	0.04%	0.03%
Mar	0.04%	0.04%	0.03%
Apr	0.03%	0.03%	0.02%
May	0.06%	0.07%	0.02%
Jun	0.04%	0.04%	0.01%
Jul	0.04%	0.04%	0.01%
Aug	0.04%	0.04%	0.02%
Sep	0.06%	0.06%	0.02%

BY QUARTER

Quarter	Overall	Display	Video
Q1	0.04%	0.04%	0.03%
Q2	0.04%	0.05%	0.02%
Q3	0.04%	0.05%	0.02%
Q4	—	—	—
YTD	**0.04%**	**0.04%**	**0.02%**

2026 YTD Jan–Sep from the DV-GAM workbook · overall and quarters weighted by DV post-bid impressions. Q4 fills in after December closes.

Newsweek

WHAT WE UPDATE

Three files, refreshed every month

1

DV-GA discrepancy workbook

Pre-bid monitoring. Comparing GA4 web pageviews with DV pre-bid requests, month by month, shows TAG and its auditors that DV monitors every pageview.

FEEDS THE REPORT'S PRE-BID SLIDE

2

DV-GAM discrepancy workbook

Post-bid monitoring. Comparing every impression GAM records with what DV records shows we also measure all post-bid impressions. Plus SIVT rate.

FEEDS THE REPORT'S SIVT SLIDE

3

IVT Monitoring Report deck

The TAG evidence pack sent to the auditor and buyers

BUILT FROM BOTH WORKBOOKS

THE ORDER MATTERS

Five steps, always in this order

1

GAM

Six columns from Ad Manager reports

DV-GAM workbook

2

DoubleVerify

Inventory Quality report (DV UI)

DV-GAM workbook

3

GA4 + DV pre-bid

Web pageviews vs pre-bid requests

DV-GA workbook

4

Quarter math

Roll months into quarters

Weighted SIVT, discrepancy

5

Deck

Refresh the report, run the final checks

Check every %

Steps 1–3 copy numbers by hand from Ad Manager, DoubleVerify and GA4 into the two workbooks. Steps 4–5 turn them into the report.

Newsweek

THE WORKBOOK IS THE REFERENCE

Three definitions every new month must follow

DISCREPANCY

(GA4 pageviews − DV pre-bid) ÷ GA4 pageviews

The DV-GA workbook's own formula. The report uses it too.

GAM TOTAL

Display: Total code served count
Video: Ad Exchange + PMP – PA + Ad server

Keeps each month comparable with the months already in the sheet.

AD EXCHANGE

Display: Banner
Video: In-stream video + In-stream video or audio

Ad Exchange impressions split by the Inventory format dimension. Video always takes both formats.

Does DV's pre-bid check see every page?

Our goal: by comparing GA4 pageviews with DV pre-bid requests, show TAG and TAG auditors that every pageview is monitored by DoubleVerify.

One sheet (Y<year>), one row per month grouped Q1–Q4, Totals row at the bottom. Feeds the report's pre-bid slide.

Column	What it holds	Source
Month of Year	The month, as YYYYMM	—
Platform	Always web	—
Pageviews	GA4 web views for the month	**GA4**
Prebid Reqs	Pages DoubleVerify's pre-bid check evaluated	**DV**
Discrepancy	(Pageviews − Prebid Reqs) ÷ Pageviews	**Formula · don't overwrite**

Newsweek

What Ad Manager counted vs what DV measured

Our goal: by comparing all impressions GAM records with what DV records, show TAG and TAG auditors that every post-bid impression is measured.

Two sheets, same columns: inpage display (ad unit newsweek) and instream video (vid.newsweek). Feeds the report's SIVT slide.

Column	What it holds	Source
Month and year	The month	—
Ad Exchange	Ad Exchange impressions (includes Private Auction)	**GAM**
Open Bidding	Open Bidding impressions	**GAM**
PMP – PA	Private Auction impressions	**GAM**
Ad server	Ad server unfiltered downloaded impressions	**GAM**
PMP – PD+PG	Preferred Deal + Programmatic Guaranteed impressions	**GAM**
GAM total	Display: Total code served count. Video: Ad Exchange + PMP – PA + Ad server	**GAM**
DV post-bid impressions	Impressions DV measured post-bid (header: total DV gross impressions – post-bid)	**DV**
DV-GAM discrepancy	1 − DV post-bid impressions ÷ GAM total	**Formula · don't overwrite**
SIVT Rate	DV's sophisticated invalid traffic rate, as a decimal	**DV**

Newsweek

01

Step 1 · Google Ad Manager

Fill the six GAM columns of the DV-GAM workbook, display and video sheets

Newsweek

STEP 1 · IN AD MANAGER

Every GAM column starts from the same report

1 **Open reports**

Reporting → Interactive reports → Create my own report → Historical

2 **Set the dates**

Date range: the months you need, e.g. Oct 1 – Dec 31

3 **Add two dimensions**

Month and year, and Ad unit (top level)

4 **Add the filter**

Ad unit (top level) is any of newsweek, vid.newsweek

5 **Add the metric and run**

One metric per column (next slide). newsweek rows → display sheet, vid.newsweek rows → video sheet

SAVE IT ONCE

One saved report per column

Save each with date range This year. Next month: open it, run it, and copy only the new month.

Newsweek

STEP 1 · COLUMN BY COLUMN

Each column is a dimension, a metric and a filter

EVERY COLUMN Dimensions: Month and year × Ad unit (top level) · Filter: Ad unit (top level) is newsweek or vid.newsweek

Column	Metric	Extra filter or split
Ad Exchange	Ad Exchange impressions	Split by Inventory format instead of ad unit: Banner → display; In-stream video + In-stream video or audio → video
Open Bidding	Total impressions	Demand channel = Open Bidding
PMP – PA	Total impressions	Demand subchannel = Private Auction
Ad server	Ad server unfiltered downloaded impressions	none
PMP – PD+PG	Total impressions	Demand subchannel = Programmatic Guaranteed or Preferred Deals
GAM total	Total code served count (display sheet)	none · video GAM total = Ad Exchange + PMP – PA + Ad server

STEP 1 · TRAPS

Three dimension traps

! **Use Ad unit (top level), not Ad unit**

! **Video Ad Exchange: In-stream video + In-stream video or audio**

! **Never filter Programmatic channel = Open Auction**

Display: 8.4% DV-GAM discrepancy YTD

Month	Ad Exchange	Open Bidding	PMP – PA	Ad server	PMP – PD+PG	GAM total	DV post-bid	Discrepancy
Jan 2026	59,956,722	16,702,295	394,000	305,167,447	41,970,488	401,193,896	370,000,000	**7.8%**
Feb 2026	49,414,587	12,696,782	681,691	256,190,688	57,789,178	343,881,118	316,400,000	**8.0%**
Mar 2026	41,371,929	3,331,694	1,115,109	266,197,908	61,479,470	356,687,943	319,200,000	**10.5%**
Apr 2026	30,069,684	324,234	281,160	150,156,640	32,154,242	201,928,491	180,600,000	**10.6%**
May 2026	25,385,109	174,602	480,923	131,495,333	27,733,589	173,744,632	158,800,000	**8.6%**
Jun 2026	24,065,724	752,608	366,829	156,355,580	23,000,403	198,169,506	183,200,000	**7.6%**
Jul 2026	25,705,283	420,408	294,269	167,812,818	22,867,169	209,708,050	193,400,000	**7.8%**
Aug 2026	26,632,518	97,845	173,863	168,385,218	21,506,886	209,971,987	194,600,000	**7.3%**
Sep 2026	39,127,849	20,567	118,486	200,945,867	24,828,773	260,491,698	241,900,000	**7.1%**
YTD	**321,729,405**	**34,521,035**	**3,906,330**	**1,802,707,499**	**313,330,198**	**2,355,777,321**	**2,158,100,000**	**8.4%**

Inpage display sheet (ad unit newsweek), 2026 YTD Jan–Sep. GAM total = Total code served count. Discrepancy = 1 − DV post-bid ÷ GAM total. Ad Exchange already includes PMP – PA.

Video: 13.3% DV-GAM discrepancy YTD

Month	Ad Exchange	Open Bidding	PMP – PA	Ad server	PMP – PD+PG	GAM total	DV post-bid	Discrepancy
Jan 2026	3,236,963	2,346,735	14,311	43,474,485	6,988,343	46,725,759	40,900,000	**12.5%**
Feb 2026	5,031,537	2,588,176	38,907	38,269,978	4,669,650	43,340,422	36,800,000	**15.1%**
Mar 2026	4,145,610	336,401	236,819	42,688,984	2,918,966	47,071,413	40,500,000	**14.0%**
Apr 2026	2,521,160	143,552	52,844	23,148,536	2,011,760	25,722,540	21,500,000	**16.4%**
May 2026	1,912,813	27,701	33,207	21,961,267	2,298,196	23,907,287	20,500,000	**14.3%**
Jun 2026	1,609,250	25,744	52,749	25,583,982	2,704,830	27,245,981	24,200,000	**11.2%**
Jul 2026	1,332,567	42,061	73,726	27,484,692	1,863,298	28,890,985	25,500,000	**11.7%**
Aug 2026	1,716,850	7,438	109,379	24,746,154	2,508,417	26,572,383	23,100,000	**13.1%**
Sep 2026	2,370,358	4,137	55,851	30,477,197	3,364,234	32,903,406	29,100,000	**11.6%**
YTD	**23,877,108**	**5,521,945**	**667,793**	**277,835,275**	**29,327,694**	**302,380,176**	**262,100,000**	**13.3%**

Instream video sheet (ad unit vid.newsweek), 2026 YTD Jan–Sep. GAM total = Ad Exchange + PMP – PA + Ad server (the sheet's formula). Discrepancy = 1 − DV post-bid ÷ GAM total. Ad Exchange includes In-stream video or audio every month.

Newsweek

02

Step 2 · DoubleVerify

DV post-bid impressions and SIVT rate, from the Inventory Quality report

STEP 2 · DV INVENTORY QUALITY REPORT

Two numbers per sheet, per month

1

DV post-bid impressions

Workbook column: total DV gross impressions – post-bid. Monitored impressions, Newsweek O&O

2

SIVT Rate

Fraud/SIVT ÷ Monitored, entered as a decimal (0.0004 = 0.04%). Goal: under 1%.

TILES ROUND TO 0.1M

370,000,000

A tile reading 370.0M goes into the workbook as 370,000,000, which is how the 2026 sheet was filled. No export needed: read the tiles in the UI.

Source: the Inventory Quality report in the DV UI (Pinnacle), for both numbers. Pull display and video as separate rows: they go to separate sheets.

STEP 2 · IN THE DV UI

Filter the Inventory Quality report by media type

1 **Open the report**

DV Pinnacle → Publisher Suite → Inventory Quality → Inventory

2 **Set one month**

Date picker: the first to the last day of the month, e.g. 7/1/2026 – 7/31/2026

3 **Add Filters → Media Type**

Tick Display (or Video) only; leave null unticked. Click Apply

4 **Read the tiles**

Monitored Impressions → DV post-bid impressions; Fraud/SIVT ÷ Monitored → SIVT Rate

5 **Repeat**

Switch the filter to Video, then move to the next month

EXAMPLE · JULY 2026

Media Type

■ Display	193.4M
□ Video	25.5M
□ null	131

193.4M is the display figure in the workbook for July. The tile rounds to 0.1M; export the report for exact counts.

Newsweek

03

Step 3 · GA4 and DV pre-bid

Pageviews against pre-bid requests, in the DV-GA workbook

Newsweek

STEP 3 · GA4 AND DV PRE-BID

Pageviews against pre-bid requests

1

Pageviews

GA4 saved exploration: Year month × Platform, metric Views, Platform = web

2

Prebid Reqs

Open report_YYYY-MM.csv in DV's shared Drive folder (right): one row per day. Sum the Total column for the month.

3

Discrepancy

Formula already in the sheet. Don't overwrite it

GA4 SOURCE OF RECORD

Account 131632414 · property 359317277
Open saved exploration

Set the date range to the new month and copy its web Views.

DV PRE-BID SOURCE

Open the shared DV folder

Folder: TAG Certification [Client Shared Folder]. Checked: the Total sums match the workbook exactly, Apr–Sep 2026.

Newsweek

04

Step 4 · Quarter math

Roll months into quarters

Newsweek

STEP 4 · ROLL MONTHS INTO QUARTERS

Weight SIVT by impressions, never average

QUARTER SIVT

Σ(DV post-bid impressions × SIVT Rate) ÷ Σ DV post-bid impressions

OVERALL SIVT

The same, with display and video summed together

DISCREPANCY

(Σ pageviews − Σ pre-bid) ÷ Σ pageviews

WORKED EXAMPLE · Q3 2026 DISPLAY SIVT

Jul 193.4M × 0.04% = 77.4K
Aug 194.6M × 0.04% = 77.8K
Sep 241.9M × 0.06% = 145.1K
300.3K ÷ 629.9M = 0.048% → 0.05%

The busiest month counts most. A plain average of the three rates (0.047%) treats a small month the same as a big one, which is why it's never used.

Every month, recompute the current quarter (quarter-to-date until its third month is in) and the YTD row.

Newsweek

05

Step 5 · Build the deck

Refresh the report and check it before it goes to TAG

Newsweek

STEP 5 · REFRESH THE REPORT

Four slides change every month

COVER

Title year

Confirm the year on the cover.

PRE-BID

GA4 vs DV pre-bid

Rebuild as the by-month and by-quarter tables shown earlier. Discrepancy = (pageviews − DV pre-bid) ÷ pageviews; the 2026 Q1–Q2 report divided by DV, so restate those.

CHANGES

Key changes

Anything that moved traffic or measurement this month: replatforming, a new video player, a vendor or threshold change.

SIVT

SIVT by month and quarter

Overall, display and video, weighted by DV post-bid impressions (Step 4). Q4 stays blank until December closes.

STEP 5 · BEFORE YOU SEND IT

Final checklist

- [ ] Both workbooks have the new month, display and video, and the Totals rows recalculate
- [ ] Ad Exchange is the full figure every month; video includes In-stream video or audio
- [ ] Discrepancies look like last month's. A jump of more than a few points gets an explanation on the Key changes slide
- [ ] SIVT is impression-weighted and under the 1% goal
- [ ] Every footnote names the year and the months covered (e.g. 2026 YTD Jan–Sep)
- [ ] IAS appears nowhere: we no longer use it, so the coverage slides name only DV and GAM
- [ ] Michael (CTO) and Kelly Liu (SVP Yield & AdOps) review it, then send it to Katrina Eddy (katrina.eddy@auditedmedia.com)

Newsweek

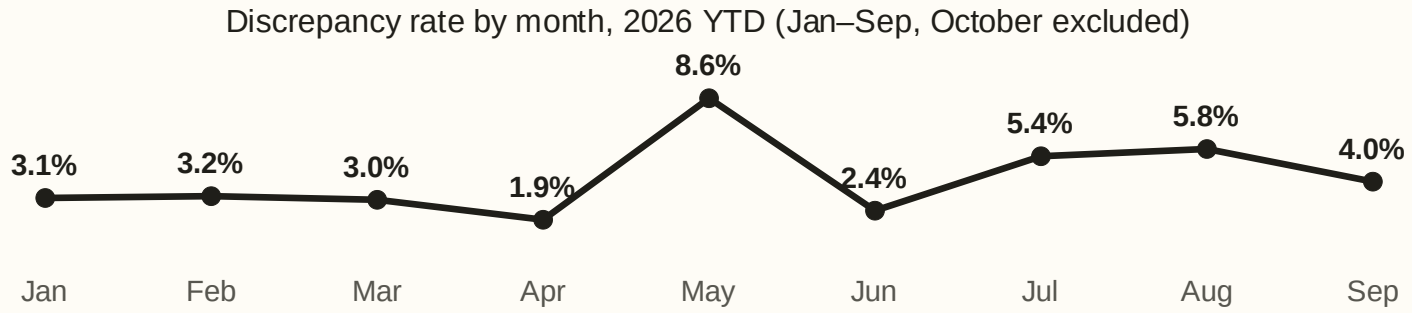
A

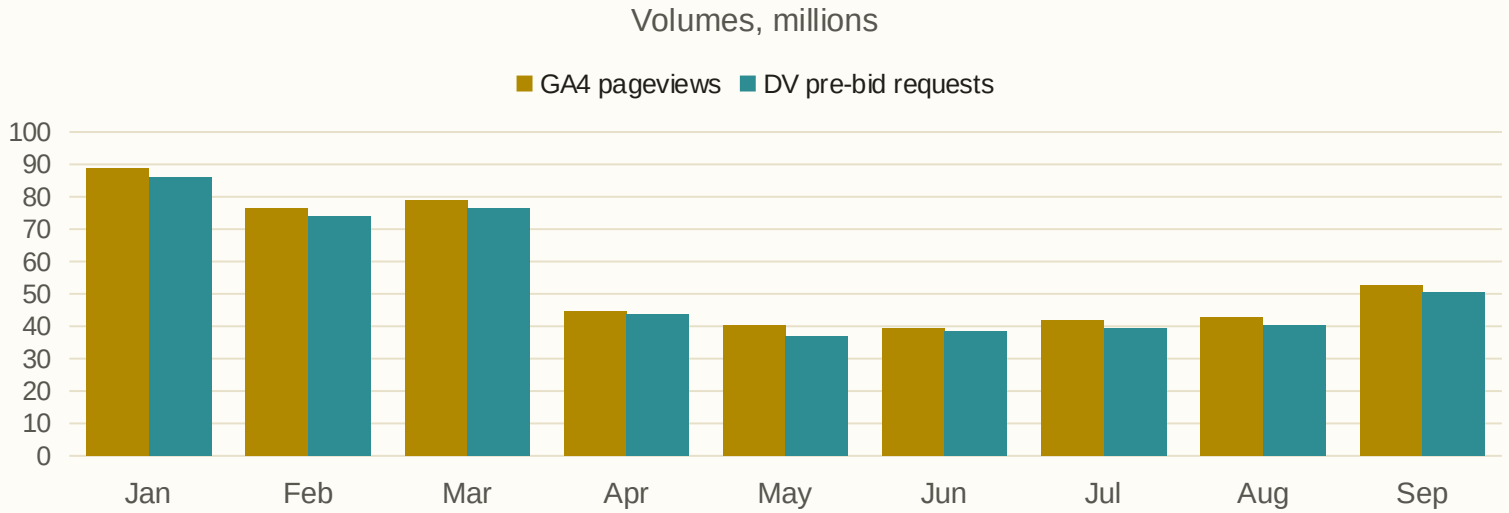
Appendix

Sanity-check charts and the yearly AAM review

Newsweek

Pre-bid discrepancy: 3.9% YTD





Source: DV-GA workbook 2026. Discrepancy = (Pageviews − Prebid Reqs) ÷ Pageviews.

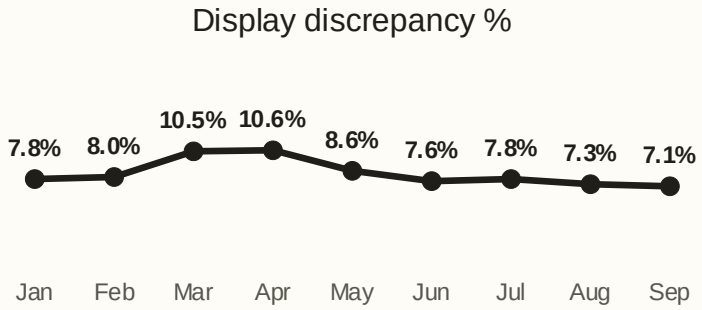
DISCREPANCY, YTD JAN–SEP

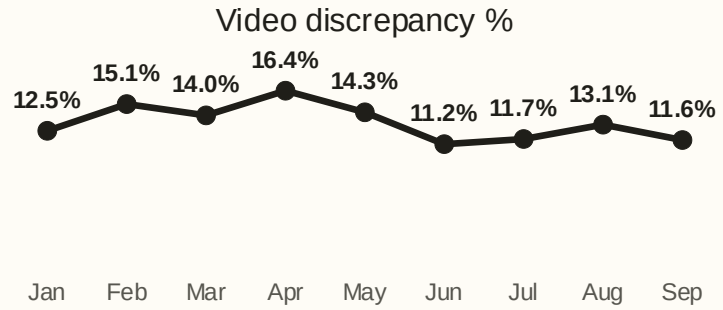
3.9%

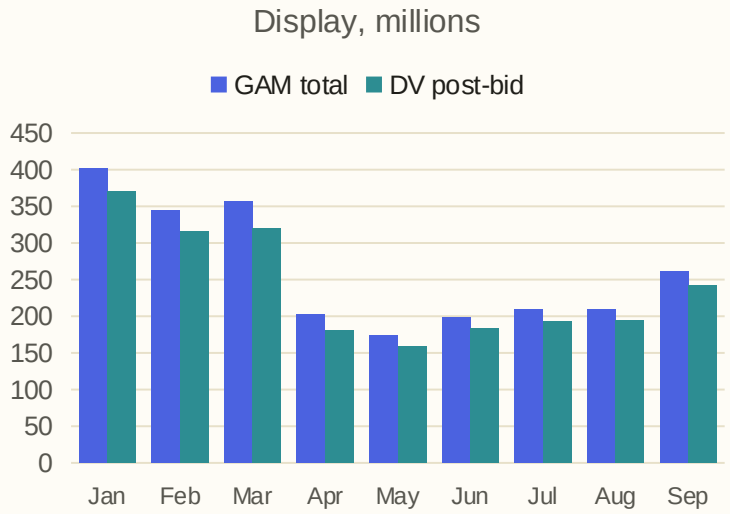
So 96.1% of pageviews were monitored by DV pre-bid: 485.97M requests against 505.70M GA4 pageviews. Highest month: May, 8.6%.

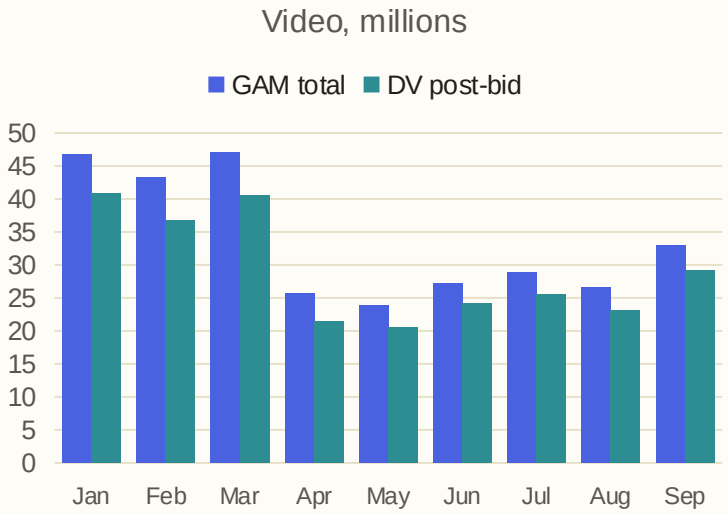
Newsweek

Post-bid discrepancy: 8.4% display, 13.3% video









DISPLAY DISCREPANCY, YTD

8.4%

91.6% of display impressions measured by DV post-bid.

VIDEO DISCREPANCY, YTD

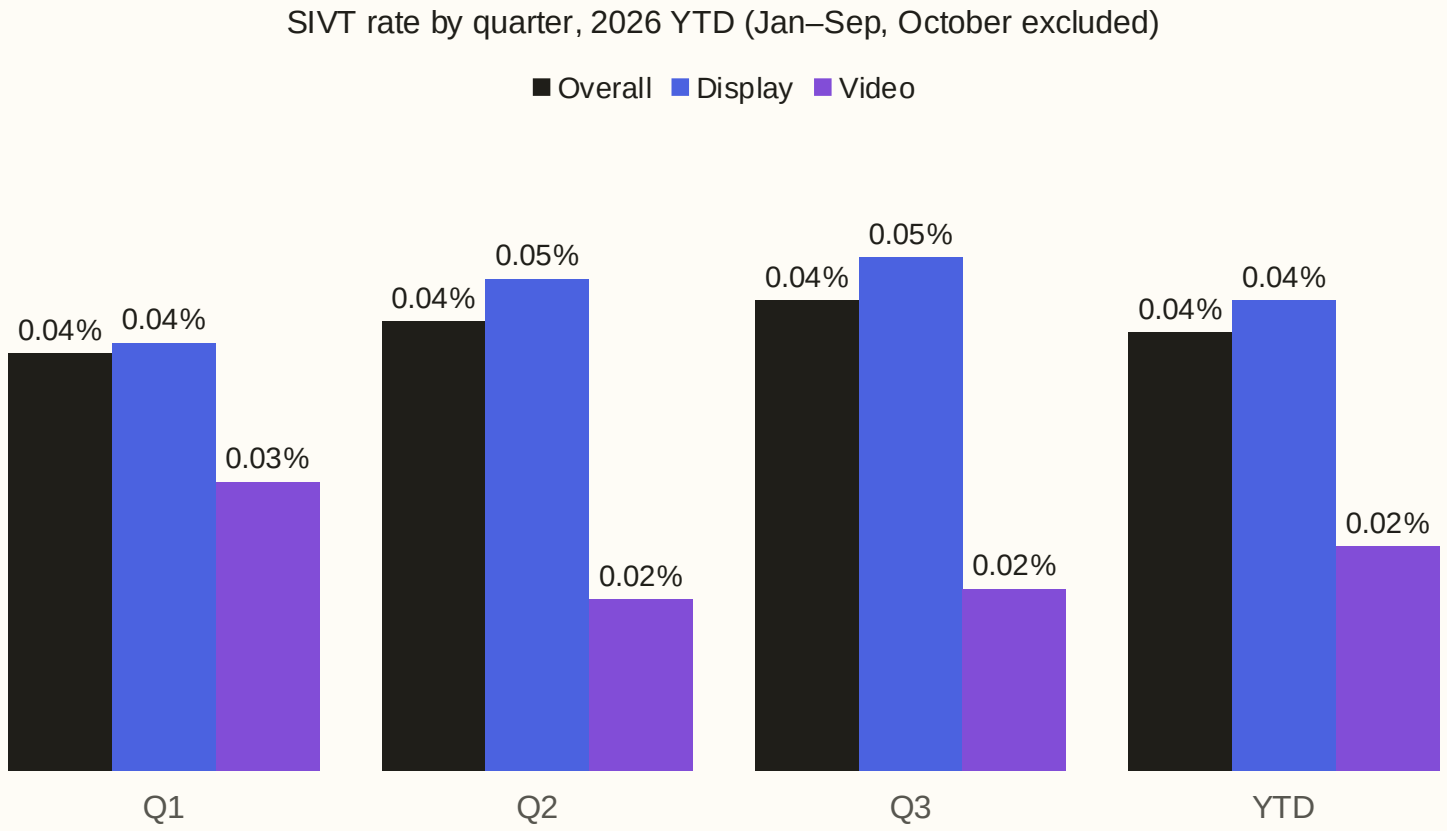
13.3%

86.7% measured. Mostly Google AdX, which DV can't scan post-bid.

Source: DV-GAM workbook, 2026 YTD Jan–Sep (October excluded). Discrepancy = 1 − DV ÷ GAM total.

Newsweek

SIVT stays well under the 1% goal



SIVT, YTD JAN–SEP

0.04%

Impression-weighted across display and video.

DISPLAY · VIDEO, YTD

0.04% · 0.02%

Each sheet's SIVT Rate weighted by DV post-bid impressions.

Source: DV-GAM workbook, SIVT Rate weighted by DV post-bid impressions. Never average the monthly rates.

Newsweek

APPENDIX · YEARLY AAM REVIEW

What AAM asks for in January

AAM (the Alliance for Audited Media) audits our TAG CAF seal once a year. After the review call, Jonathan Reid sends a list of evidence to drop in the shared folder. Last year's list:

- ☐ **The report deck**
  This deck, as presented on the call
- ☐ **DV IVT screenshots**
  IVT rates from the DV UI
- ☐ **DV raw pre-bid data**
  The monthly CSVs, plus DV's emails for months sent by email
- ☐ **GA4 screenshots**
  Pageview counts, by month
- ☐ **Discrepancy report**
  The DV-GAM workbook, display and video
- ☐ **DV post-bid screenshots**
  Back up the workbook's DV numbers, display and video
- ☐ **ads.txt evidence**
  Screenshot of the update log, plus one sample update ticket
- ☐ **Complaint process**
  Confirm it hasn't changed; an example if one happened
- **~~IAS screenshots~~**
  No longer applies: we stopped using IAS

Newsweek

Questions they ask, and last year's answers

They ask	Last year's answer
Any material changes since last year?	Say so, e.g. we dropped IAS in 2026
What share of traffic does DV scan?	Display 100%; video 1–5% (sampled)
Which DV lists do you ingest pre-bid?	None. DV runs client-side on the page (Michael confirmed, Jan 2026)
Any traffic that can't be scanned?	Google AdX: DV's wrapper can't go on exchange tags, so post-bid covers ad-server traffic only
Where's the Description of Methodology?	advertising.newsweek.com/#about-section. Check the link still works
Do you need a sellers.json?	No: Newsweek is a publisher. Make sure each exchange lists us in its sellers.json
Who responds to fraud incidents?	The CTO, supported by the Director of Operations and the VP of Ad Ops

They also re-check ads.txt (newsweek.com/ads.txt) with third-party validators and send back any errors. Source: AAM emails, Jan–Apr 2026.